PSS4 One Page Baseline Protocol

CAP 5627 Project 2.1 | Questionnaires vs. Natural Conversations
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Purpose and setup. Measure agreement between first automatic categorization and paired closed-ended PSS-4 answers, using the professor-approved fallback described in the supplied instructions. Bring the full project folder, Chrome or Edge laptop, this protocol and replacement trial workbook. No network, eEVA login, camera or microphone is needed. Record browser, version and interruptions.

Participants and consent. Use voluntary adult teammates/classmates. Before starting, obtain agreement to typed-response collection and explain that participation is optional and may stop without penalty. Do not claim consent until obtained. Assign P01, P02 and similar codes; keep names separate. Ask the professor before involving anyone outside class. No faces or voices are recorded.

Before counted trials. Run 1–2 human team trials labeled Team dry run. Software examples are labeled Synthetic software test. Exclude both from actual baseline summaries. Freeze the app and record file hashes. After any fix, assign a new version, document the change and restart the affected trial series.

Exact participant instructions. “You will answer four questions about experiences during the last month in two formats. Please answer based on your own experience. In the choice format, choose the option that fits best. In the text format, answer in your own words about how often it happened. There are no right or wrong personal experiences. You may stop at any time.”

Procedure and order. Assign and record AB or BA before starting: three of each for six people, or a 3/2 split for five. Select Offline fallback baseline for actual classroom trials. Use identical question wording/order in both formats. A has five unselected original choices; B accepts typed answers. Keep researcher tools closed. Start the other format after the first finishes.

Clarification and missing answers. A clear B answer advances. An unclear answer gets one prompt: “Could you describe how often that happened during the last month?” If still unclear, show the five original choices and log structured fallback with automatic failure. One empty prompt is allowed; two consecutive empty B responses record unanswered. A requires a selection. If someone stops, use New participant to retain answered items and flag the current missing item.

Timing and outcome definitions. Condition timing begins with question 1 and ends after item 4, including clarification/fallback. Setup and the between-format break are excluded. Pair raw 0–4 categories within participant, question, session and version. Primary agreement uses the first automatic answer; clarified automatic agreement is secondary. Exclude manual fallback/unanswered from automatic agreement but retain them in coverage/fallback rates. Correct means exact category match, not clinical correctness.

Logging and summaries. Retain every failure, disagreement, missing answer and interruption. Export CSV and JSON after each session and verify in Excel. Select fallback and the frozen version in the workbook. Report participant count, eligible pairs, exact matches/percent, descriptive kappa when defined, mapping coverage, clarification/fallback rates, and completed-run count plus median/min/max seconds by condition. Reverse Q2/Q3 only for the total PSS-4 score. Actual results remain pending until collected.

Protection and errors. Save anonymous exports in a restricted local folder, without uploads. Recovery depends on browser policy and is not the archive. After a crash/reload, retain interrupted rows, document the event, export and restart under a new code. Do not selectively discard failures; document exclusions. Collect a few genuine pilot trials for October 26; finish the full baseline by November 9.